

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1157

By Johnson

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Alberto R. Gonzales for his distinguished career in public service.

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that the members of this General Assembly should honor those individuals who, through their professional achievements and public service, have made significant contributions to the advancement of the law and the betterment of their communities; and

WHEREAS, Alberto R. Gonzales is one such estimable individual, whose distinguished career in law and public service has spanned state, national, and academic leadership; and

WHEREAS, after attending the United States Air Force Academy, Mr. Gonzales received a Bachelor of Arts degree from Rice University and a Juris Doctor degree from Harvard Law School, establishing the strong academic foundation that would support his distinguished legal career; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Gonzales has served with distinction as dean of Belmont University College of Law and presently holds the Doyle Rogers Distinguished Chair of Law, providing thoughtful leadership and guidance in the education and preparation of future members of the legal profession; and

WHEREAS, during his tenure at Belmont University, Alberto Gonzales has strengthened the standing of the College of Law as a respected institution of legal education while fostering a culture of academic excellence, professional integrity, and public service among its students; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Gonzales has compiled an extensive and distinguished record of public service, including service as the Attorney General of the United States during the administration

of President George W. Bush, as Counsel to the President, and as a Justice on the Supreme Court of Texas; and

WHEREAS, Alberto Gonzales's service at the national and state levels also includes roles as the Texas Secretary of State and General Counsel to the Governor of Texas; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his government service, Mr. Gonzales practiced law in the private sector as a partner with the Houston-based law firm of Vinson & Elkins and served as a visiting professor and recruitment consultant at Texas Tech University; and

WHEREAS, in each of these roles, he demonstrated a commitment to the rule of law and to the careful consideration of complex legal issues at the highest levels of government; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Gonzales has also rendered valuable service through his involvement with the Uniform Law Commission, contributing to its mission of developing well-drafted, nonpartisan legislation that promotes clarity, stability, and uniformity in state laws; and

WHEREAS, through his work with the Uniform Law Commission, Alberto Gonzales has contributed to strengthening and harmonizing the legal frameworks upon which state governments rely, thereby supporting the effective administration of justice and the consistent application of law across the United States; and

WHEREAS, throughout his career, Mr. Gonzales has exemplified integrity, leadership, and dedication to public service, earning the respect and admiration of colleagues, students, and the broader legal community; and

WHEREAS, Alberto Gonzales has received numerous honors, including recognition as a Distinguished Alumnus of Rice University, the Harvard Law School Association Award, the Central Intelligence Agency Director's Award, and the Office of the Secretary of Defense Medal for Exceptional Public Service; and

WHEREAS, he has also been recognized nationally for his contributions as a leader and role model, including being named Hispanic American of the Year by *HISPANIC* magazine and one of the twenty-five most influential Hispanics in America by *TIME Magazine*; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we recognize Mr. Gonzales for his many contributions to the legal profession and for the positive impact he has made on the institutions he has served; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Alberto R. Gonzales for his distinguished career in public service, his leadership at Belmont University College of Law, and his contributions to the Uniform Law Commission and extend to him our best wishes for continued success in all his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.